

Back Pain Exercises for Seniors - Printable Pack

From *Back Pain Exercises for Seniors* by Margaret Hale (Oro Enigma Publishing). Print as many copies as you need.

The 8-Week Tracker

A tick for the daily routine, an A or a B for a strength session, the minutes for a walk, and the back's score out of ten the next morning.

Week	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun	Next-morning back (0 to 10)
1								
2								
3								
4								
5								
6								
7								
8								

The Test Sheet

Test	Before Week 1 (date)	After Week 4 (date)	After Week 8 (date)	3 months later
30-second chair stand (number of stands; note "with hands" if used)				
Timed up and go (seconds; note "with stick" if used)				
Morning stiffness (minutes until the back moves freely)				
Pain on rising from a chair (0 to 10)				
Walking tolerance (minutes before the back or legs make you stop)				
My direction (flexion-intolerant / extension-intolerant / neither)				
My normal range for my age (chair stand, from Chapter 4)				

The 30-second chair stand: normal range by age (the middle half of healthy people)

Age	Women (number of stands)	Men (number of stands)
60 to 64	12 to 17	14 to 19
65 to 69	11 to 16	12 to 18
70 to 74	10 to 15	12 to 17
75 to 79	10 to 15	11 to 17
80 to 84	9 to 14	10 to 15
85 to 89	8 to 13	8 to 14
90 to 94	4 to 11	7 to 12

Timed up and go: under 10 seconds is normal; 10 to 14 is worth improving; over about 13.5 goes with a raised risk of falls (tell the doctor).

The Pain Rule Card

During the exercise	What to do
0 to 2 out of 10	Carry on; when it is easy, do more
3 to 5	Acceptable, if the back is back to normal by the next morning
6 or more, a sharp catch, or any pain spreading down a leg	Stop that exercise; the easier version, or leave it out; that direction is out until the leg is quiet
The next morning	
Same or better than yesterday morning	The session was right
Worse: more pain, more stiffness, the leg	The session was too much: fewer repetitions, the easier version, no load next time
A doctor, now	New bladder or bowel trouble or numbness around the seat (hospital, the same hour); a weak or dragging foot; back pain after a fall in a thin bone or sudden severe mid-back pain; fever, weight loss, a cancer history, or pain every night that no position eases; pain steadily worse over weeks

My Precautions

Diagnosis, operation or fracture, and date	
My direction (Chapter 3)	
Exercises or movements to avoid, and until when	
Osteoporosis: yes / no (no forward bending under load, no sit-ups, no twisting with weight)	
Medicines that matter (blood thinners, blood pressure, steroids)	
Who to call, and the number	

The Direction Card

Flexion-intolerant (worse bending forward and sitting; the disc-type back)	Extension-intolerant (worse standing and walking; the stenosis-type back)
Lying face down and the press-up; standing back bends after every sit; the hinge; walking; no forward bending under load; knee-to-chest and child's pose small or out	Knee-to-chest; pelvic tilt; child's pose; the corset; hip flexor stretches; walking with a lean on a trolley or poles; the bicycle; no back bends or press-ups

The 10-Minute Daily Routine

	Exercise	Dose
1	Lying pelvic tilt, in bed	10
2	Knee rolls, in bed	10 each way
3	The log roll out of bed	Once
4	Seated pelvic tilt, settle in neutral	10
5	Seated cat and cow	10 rounds
6	Seated marching	20 each leg
7	The belly brace	Hold 10 s, 5 times
8	Seated twist and side bend	3 each way
9	Seated hamstring stretch	30 s each leg
10	Sit to stand with the hinge; wall check	5 stands; 3 tucks
Then	Flexion-intolerant: 5 standing back bends. Extension-intolerant: knee-to-chest.	

Session A (the corset, lying down)

	Exercise	Dose
Warm-up	Daily routine 1 to 5, or a 5-minute walk	
1	Lying pelvic tilt with the brace	10
2	Bridge	8 to 12, 2 sets
3	Dead bug	8 each side, 2 sets
4	The curl-up	Hold 8 s, 6 times, 2 sets
5	Side plank on the knees	Hold 8 to 10 s, 4 each side
6	Clamshell	12 to 15 each side, 2 sets
7	Lying face down and press-up (flexion-intolerant) or knee-to-chest (extension-intolerant)	As the page says
8	Face-down leg lift (from Week 5)	8 to 10 each leg
Stretch	Figure-four, hip flexor lying, knee rolls	30 s each; 10 rolls

Session B (the hinge and the hips)

	Exercise	Dose
Warm-up	Daily routine 1 to 5, or a 5-minute walk	
1	Cat and cow on hands and knees	10 rounds
2	Bird dog	Hold 8 s, 6 each side, 2 sets
3	Child's pose (extension-intolerant, neutral) or standing back bends (flexion-intolerant)	30 to 60 s; or 10
4	The hip hinge with a stick	10, 2 sets
5	Squat to the chair	8 to 12, 2 sets
6	Wall posture check and chin tuck	Hold 10 s, 5 times
7	Lifting a bag, light (from Week 5)	5
8	Getting up from the floor (from Week 3, once)	Once
Stretch	Standing hamstring, hip flexor standing, calf	30 s each, twice

The Flare Routine

	What	How often
1	Keep moving: a slow walk round the house or garden	Every hour you are awake
2	Pelvic tilt and knee rolls in bed	Morning, evening, and any time you lie down
3	The direction that eases it (Chapter 3), little and often	6 to 8 times a day, a few repetitions
4	Heat on the muscle spasm	20 minutes, 3 times a day
5	The log roll, the hinge, no lifting, no long sitting, no long drives	All week
6	An anti-inflammatory for a few days if you are allowed one (Chapter 12)	With food
Then	Days 3 to 7 the daily routine at the easier versions; week 2 Session A; restart the plan two weeks earlier than you left it	